Bangladesh War and the new turn of militancy in the state beginning from 1987.[13]

In January 1969, Zahgir, Fazl-ul-Haq Qureshi and Musadaq Husain returned to India from Pakistan via Punjab. They then made their way back to Srinagar. Nazir Ahmad Wani was eagerly waiting for them. The old networks were reactivated and new members recruited. Having achieved this, in May 1969, Zahgir, Qureshi and Wani then travelled back to Pakistan where they received specific instructions from PIB's Zafar Iqbal Rathore, Brig. Asghar and Maj. Tufail. The latter two were, in all probability, ISI officers seconded to assist Rathore. Wani received military instruction and learnt how to operate machine guns, rifles, hand grenades and explosives. All of them were taught how to fabricate improvised explosive devices from easily available materials such as potassium chlorate and arsenic sulphide. In July 1969, they returned to India, again via Punjab and started teaching courses in guerilla combat tactics for eight recruits in the Hak-Khul forests above the village of Arizal, in Beerwah. Significantly, this was the same village where some years earlier, in May 1965, in the run-up to Operation Gibraltar, the subversive group of Hayat Mir, an affiliate of the Master Cell, had carried out a savage terrorist attack. It was also the place where an old prison mate of theirs, Salim Jehangir Khan, a former Pakistani covert operative, had opened a poultry farm. This poultry farm would serve as a cover for Al-Fatah's training activities. All of their time was spent in building up the organisation and fine-tuning their tradecraft. In January 1970, Zahgir again travelled to Pakistan, this time with two new members of Al-Fatah—Bashir Ahmed and Gulzar Ahmed 'Khaki'. Zahgir provided his case officer and the ISI support team with a detailed account of Al-Fatah's organisation-building activities as well as some intelligence of military value. The group was now told it was time to act. Rathore told Zahgir that he would shortly be posted to the Pakistan High Commission in New Delhi. A fortnight later, the group returned to Srinagar. Their first target would be the office of the education department at Pulwama.

Late on the night of 1 April 1970, Zahgir's group travelled in a stolen jeep to Pulwama. Outside the education department's office, they